

Outlook

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Sent	Wed, 18 Dec 2019 12:14:00 -0000

Quick question: schema drift is becoming a reporting risk

Morning,

I need help with something that sounds simple but probably is not.

Data Engineering sees changing schemas and needs to distinguish safe expansion from business-definition drift. Several teams are reporting more failed or retried activity than they expected, but they do not agree on the cause. There are enough data exceptions to make a polished average dangerous; preserve the unresolved cases.

The questions I would ask in the room are:

1. What would we expect to see if new fields are additive?
2. What evidence would instead support that renamed or recoded fields break history?
3. How do we rule out that null patterns reveal a source rollout rather than missing customer data?

We looked at a version of this before. For the December 2019 review, please show what changed and whether the earlier conclusion still holds. Please work towards the data contract, quarantine rule and backfill requirement. A useful output would be a control view with the exceptions, owner and reason each item was included.

Use monthly account snapshots, status events, limits, product enrolments and signatories; monthly customer and KYC snapshots; transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; the latest closed loan files available by the request date, including affordability, pricing and origination risk fields. One caution: A technical schema match does not prove semantic consistency; business owners must confirm meaning.

Regards